

1. How have you demonstrated a commitment to the Uber Career Prep program's mission?

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My commitment to the mission of the Uber Career Prep program stems from a deeply personal journey, one that began with a dream and transformed into a mission to empower others. In Bangladesh, where the idea of studying abroad is often seen as a distant luxury, reserved for the few, I founded a non-profit with a simple goal: to make this dream accessible to all, regardless of socio-economic status.

This initiative was born out of my own experiences and challenges when I was applying for higher education abroad. I realized that many talented students in my community were held back not by a lack of ability, but by a lack of resources and proper mentorship. Determined to bridge this gap, I started by conducting workshops and mentoring sessions at first. Gradually, my team and I developed a platform where students could access information, receive mentorship, and connect with scholarships and opportunities. We aimed to create an environment where dreams were nurtured, and ambitions were encouraged. We organized community events, brought in speakers who had studied abroad, and created a support network for aspiring students. These efforts led us to reach about a million talented and ambitious students in Bangladesh.

Through this journey, I learned the true value of mentorship, diversity, and accessibility in education. Each student we helped was an example of the potential that lies in breaking down barriers and opening doors to opportunities. This experience aligns closely with the Uber Career Prep program's mission of fostering diversity in tech. In the tech world, I see a reflection of my mission in this program. It is the same spirit of inclusivity, empowerment, and commitment to diversity that I bring to the Career Prep program.

2. What matters most to you and why? Share the insights and experiences that shaped your perspective.

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The tech world to me is where cold logic meets the warmth of human creativity. This interesting collaboration creates magical things, giving me the joy of creating and at the same time, touching lives around the globe. This unique blend of happiness and impact is what matters most to me.

My journey began with a low-end computer, which still was considered a luxury back then. To me, all that a computer could do is play Power Ranger movies and run Need for Speed. And then one day my friend wrote some lines of HTML code in a paper and asked me to run it on my PC. I followed all the steps and saw a webpage come to life. I thought coding meant

scribbling green letters on a black background, as I had seen in movies. I realized it was something I could also do, and my learning journey started.

I discovered my happiness. Each line of code I wrote gave me joy, and each successful program was a triumph. But I gradually realized that it wasn't just coding that brought me happiness, it was the realization of its impact. I recall the first time I created a simple website for a local non-profit, nothing fancy, a one-pager. The gratitude in their eyes showed the difference it made to their cause. And that was a revelation - my skills could change lives.

In my hands, code becomes a tool to bridge gaps, to solve problems, and to create beauty. And now, every day, when I wake up and open VS Code, I am reminded that, in my small way, I am contributing to something much larger than myself. That is what matters the most to me.

3. What are your immediate career goals following the completion of this program?

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Upon completing the Uber Career Prep Program, my immediate ambition is to secure an internship at a leading-edge tech company. I envision myself in an environment where the products we develop touch millions of lives, shaping the future with every line of code.

This isn't just a career choice; it's a quest to be at the forefront of technological revolution. I dream of contributing to products that redefine how we interact with technology. In this fast-paced setting, I anticipate the thrill of seeing ideas morph into reality at lightning speed.

Post-graduation, I plan to transition into product management. Why product management, you ask? Because it's there, at the confluence of technology, business, and user experience, that I believe I can make the most significant impact. It's about being the architect of solutions, crafting experiences that resonate with millions, and witnessing the tangible impact of my work. This role aligns perfectly with my passion for technology and my drive to create.

As I stand at the threshold of this exciting journey, I am equipped with technical skills and a vision to make a difference. The Uber Career Prep Program is more than a learning experience; it's a launchpad that will propel me toward my goals, arming me with the skills, insights, and network necessary to thrive in the tech industry.

4. Please share a story about a time when you demonstrated perseverance.

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At 15, armed with a soldering iron to build a line-following robot, I embarked on a journey that tested my perseverance.

My first encounter with it was a disaster. I remember watching a YouTube tutorial with stars in my eyes, thinking, "How hard can it be?" Famous last words, indeed. My initial attempts were less about soldering and more about creating modern art with metal and circuits. Every burnt circuit board was a blow to my confidence, burning my dreams, quite literally, frustrating me to the point that I mistakenly started touching the hot iron with my bare hands.

Reaching the peak of burning pain and losing hope, I thought, "Let's take a pause and start over". It was not about getting the neat soldering anymore, it was about proving to myself that I could learn, adapt, and succeed. I reached out to a local electronics hobbyist group, where seasoned tinkerers shared their wisdom. They saw in me a reflection of their younger selves – eager yet unsteady. Under their guidance, I learned not just the technicalities of soldering but the art behind it – the precision, the patience, and the steady hand it required.

With each passing day, my skills sharpened. The loose solder joints became tighter. And then, one day, after countless hours of trial and error, I finally completed my circuit board. The robot was complete, telling stories of my perseverance in the scarred circuit board.

This soldering iron journey taught me perseverance from the core. I realized it's more than just enduring; it's about evolving. This lesson still keeps me going in any challenging situations I face, be it a group project or a coding problem. I bring the same determination to this program, with the belief that any challenge can be transformed into a story of growth.